

SOCIAL ANXIETY DISORDER – DATA

1. I cannot walk into a room full of people without feeling like everyone is staring at me.
2. I avoided my own birthday party because the idea of being the center of attention made me physically sick.
3. I rehearse what I will say before every conversation and I still freeze when the moment comes.
4. I eat alone every day at work because sitting with a group of people feels unbearable.
5. **I turned down the promotion because it required presenting to a room of people. I could not do it.**
6. The thought of speaking in public makes me physically ill for days in advance.
7. I cannot make a phone call in front of other people. I step outside or wait until I am alone.
8. I have gone home in tears after perfectly ordinary interactions that I felt I handled catastrophically.
9. I avoid eye contact with strangers because making eye contact feels like an invitation to be judged.
10. I declined the job interview because it included a group exercise and I cannot perform in front of others.
11. I sit at the back of every classroom so fewer people can see me.
12. I over-apologize in every social interaction because I assume I have already said something wrong.
13. **I cannot order food at a counter if there are people behind me. The pressure is too much.**
14. After every conversation I replay it looking for every mistake I may have made.
15. I have cancelled plans with friends so many times that they have stopped inviting me.
16. I keep my expression deliberately controlled in social situations because I fear others seeing my anxiety.

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17. I decline offers of help because accepting them requires acknowledgement and brief interaction.
18. I send emails instead of calls and texts instead of emails to minimise direct interaction.
19. I feel that the real version of me would horrify people, so I keep a controlled mask in place.
20. I travel to shops at unusual hours specifically to avoid other customers.
21. The fear of public humiliation governs almost every significant decision in my life.
22. I feel like I don't belong anywhere there are people. Like I was not built for human company.
23. I have missed professional opportunities because I could not attend networking events.
24. I practice conversations in the mirror so I will not sound stupid when they actually happen.
25. I practice what I will say in the mirror before calling even close friends I have known for years.